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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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General Comment

As a tax-paying US citizen and software engineer with over two decades in the field, I am compelled to register my sincere and severe objections to this plan. The sort of "AI" about which this plan is concerned is, primarily, plagiarism engines with no capacity to construct an understanding of the underlying information they ingest. This is why, for instance, the Columbia Journalism Review recently found that, of the most popular "AI"-powered search tools, all had profoundly high error rates when it came to accuracy in their data, while they also produced very plausible-sounding and confident wrong answers. (https://www.cjr.org/tow_center/we-compared-eight-ai-search-engines-theyre-all-bad-at-citing-news.php) Rushing into investing in these tools in the way this policy describes not only skips over the fundamental category errors in the way they are being marketed, but also undermines existing productive markets in the US economy. Sam Altman, the CEO of OpenAI, recently stated that "it would be impossible to train today's leading AI models without using copyrighted materials," making it clear that this plan would be used to violate copyrights that are essential to protecting actual innovators in fields ranging from mathematics and sciences to engineering to journalism to arts and literature. (<https://committees.parliament.uk/writtenevidence/126981/pdf/>) Already, these tools have done great damage to industries by replacing competence labor force with tools that are far inferior or wholly incapable of producing the kind of work for which they are being sold. For example, just two years ago, CNET replaced their financial news desk with "AI," which went on to pen articles with glaring, simple, and crucial errors. (<https://futurism.com/cnet-ai-errors>) There are other issues with the "AI" industry, as well, such as the environmental impact, which, given the administration's lack of concern for global climate change, may not be a major issue in this deliberation. (<https://www.instituteforenergyresearch.org/climate-change/big-corporations-are-abandoning-their-climate-commitments/>) That said, this increased emissions go hand-in-hand with a tremendous energy demand, making it harder for the US to become independent of foreign sources of fossil fuels. Lifting regulations on this industry in general further commits us to this unreliable technology without concern for the wide-ranging negative impacts on the US economy, workforce, and energy independence.

Thank you for your consideration and take care,